

The Garamut "The message sender"

Ps Barry Reflections from 'The WORD'!

For PRAYER, PROCLAMATION & PERSONAL PROGRESS

Bethel Global Missions

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THEME: SEEING THE BEAUTIFUL.

TO BE PEOPLE THAT ARE LOOKING FOR THE BEAUTIFUL AND LESS ON THE UGLY.

IT IS SO EASY TO SEE THE NEGATIVE SIDE OF THE WORLD AROUND US WITH ALL ITS HYPOCRACY, ANGER AND RESENTMENT TO ONE ANOTHER.
THERE ARE WARS AND NATIONS AGAINST NATIONS AND THERE ARE PARTS OF THE WORLD THAT HAVE BEEN DEVASTATED BY FLOODS, EARTHQUAKES, DEATH AND DESEASE AND ALL-AROUND US.

THERE IS UGLINESS IN THIS WORLD.

- The ugliness of seeing the inhumanity of man to man.
- Seeing the abuse and suffering of children because of the ravages of war and conflict.
- Viewing the trafficking of women and children into the slave and sex trade.
- It is ugly to see the results of drug addiction and degradation in people's lives.
- It is ugly and unpleasant to see the destruction of lives, marriages and the domestic violence in families, all as a result of anger, compulsive gambling and mental stress etc.

YES, THERE IS UGLINESS IN THIS WORLD, BUT THERE IS ALSO BEAUTY AROUND US AND IF WE LOOK FOR IT, THOSE BEAUTIFUL THINGS WILL INSPIRE HOPE AND THANKS TO GOD FOR THEM.

LIFE IN GENERAL IS LIKE THAT.

WHERE WE OFTEN FIND IT EASIER TO SEE THE NEGATIVE SIDE OF PEOPLE'S LIVES RATHER THAN THEIR GOOD SIDE.
AND THIS APPLIES TO HOW WE SEE ALL PEOPLES - SAINTS AND SINNERS.
LET US NOT LOSE SIGHT OF THE THINGS THAT ARE BEAUTIFUL EVEN THOUGH THEY MAY HAPPEN AS NORMAL ROUTINE OF LIFE.

EXAMPLES OF BEAUTIFUL THINGS.

- TO SEE CHRIST'S CHOICE TO BECOME A SERVANT, HIS CONDECENSION AND SUFFERING ON THE CROSS, COMING DOWN, HIS STOOPING DOWN TO LIFT US UP GAVE US IDENTITY, WORTH AND DIGNITY - THERE WE SEE MAJESTIC BEAUTY. *Psalms 18:35 You have stooped to make me great. NCV*
- THERE IS THE "BEAUTY OF THE RESILIENCE" OF PEOPLE AS THEY RISE UP OUT OF TRAGEDY AND SORROW AND STILL HAVE A GOOD HEART AND NO BITTERNESS. THAT'S BEAUTIFUL.
- AND THERE IS ALSO THE BEAUTY OF CHRISTIAN BELIEVERS AFTER HAVING FACED SOME OF THE MOST DIFFICULT AND CHALLENGING TRIALS OF LIFE ARE STILL ABLE TO THANK AND PRAISE GOD. WHERE THEY DO NOT ASK THE QUESTION, "WHY GOD?" BUT GENUINELY MAINTAINING A GOD HEART ATTITUDE AND APPRECIATION TO GOD. THAT'S BEAUTIFUL.

- **THEN THERE IS THE BEAUTY OF A ONE OR MORE PERSONS SHOWING FORGIVENNESS RATHER THAN REVENGE TO THOSE WHO HAVE HURT, OFFENDED, MISREPRESENTED AND TREATED BADLY BY RELEASING OTHERS THROUGH FORGIVENESS AND LOVE. THAT'S BEAUTIFUL AND SPECIAL.**
- **ALSO, SEEING THE LILY BLOSSOMING IN THE MIDST OF HARSHNESS OF THORNS – THE BRIDES LOVE CONTINUING TO FLOURISH AND SHINE FORTH REGARDLESS OF THE OPPOSITION OF THORNS. THAT IS BEAUTIFUL.**

Song of Solomon 2:2 Like a lily among thistles is my darling among young women. NLT
Song of Solomon 2:2 As the lily among thorns, so is my love among the daughters. Webster.

- **THE BEAUTY OF SALVATION – OF PEOPLE COMING TO CHRIST AND BEING SAVED. THAT'S BEAUTIFUL.**
- **SEEING A SINNER'S LIFE REBORN AND TRANSFORMED INTO A COMPLETELY DIFFERENT PERSON - THAT IS BEAUTIFUL TO SEE.**
- **WE ALSO SHOULD BE CONTINUING TO REFLECT UPON THE BEAUTY OF SEEING DISCIPLES GROW AND PRODUCE FRUIT THAT IS PLEASING TO GOD. THIS KIND OF BEAUTY NEVER LOSES ITS LUSTRE OR BRILLIANCY. LEARNING TO APPRECIATE THE BEAUTY OF EVERYDAY THINGS OF LIFE.**

- **SUCH AS BEING ALIVE – for only the living can we work, plan and know things; there is nothing from the grave.**

Ecclesiastes 9:4 Anyone who is among the living has hope—even a live dog is better off than a dead lion! NIV

Ecclesiastes 9:10 Whatever you do, do well, for in death, where you are going, there is no working or planning, or knowing, or understanding.

- **HAVING A WIFE, CHILDREN, A CHURCH TO ATTEND AND FRIENDS AND FELLOWSHIP. THAT IS A BEAUTIFUL THING.**

THE BEAUTY OF THE SIMPLE THINGS IN LIFE THAT BRINGS US JOY. E.G.

- **THE BIRTHING OF A BABY INTO THIS WORLD – THAT'S BEAUTIFUL.**
- **SEEING CHILDREN HUGGING AND SHOWING AFFECTION TO THEIR DAD OR MUM. THAT'S PURE BEAUTY.**
- **TO SEE A MIRACULOUS HEALING OR A DELIVERANCE FROM OPPRESSION AND EVIL FORCES - THAT IS BEAUTIFUL.**

My personal Testimony
Of seeing the beauty of God's provision.

In many of my ministry patrols of presenting the gospel of salvation to the remote villages of Papua New Guinea, the place where I am to lay down to sleep each night varied from place to place.
Many times, it consisted only of the jungle floor, or a piece of plywood or old wooden door or a woven bamboo platform in the open with no walls or roof over my head. My backpack as my pillow and a mosquito net as my only home for the night. But before I slept, I gave thanks to God with these words – *"thank you Lord and this is my Cathedral tonight that you have provided for me, watch over me" Amen.*
I truly saw and confessed with a grateful heart that each night regardless of the conditions, that it was "my Cathedral" provided by God. To me that sleeping place was beautiful.

- **CAN I ENCOURAGE EACH OF YOU READING THIS REFLECTION THAT YOU START EACH DAY BY COUNTING THE BEAUTIFUL THINGS THAT YOU ALREADY HAVE AND SEE - and then give thanks for them.**
- **WE NEED TO LOOK FOR THE POSITIVE EVEN IN THE MIDST OF THE NEGATIVE- AND THE BEAUTY IN THE MIDST OF THE UGLY.**

AMEN Ps Barry.